

Colin Levine

AMAN: Creating Without a Label

credits	
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medium	Fashion & music

For Collin Levine, who designs and records music under the name AMAN, art isn't something he does; it's the way he moves through life. "My life experiences shape my music. So, if I'm going through something... my music is like an outlet for that. It's kind of like a diary or a journal for me." He says, sometimes, though, "I just want to make something just for the fuck of it."

The 23-year-old artist first realized music was more than a hobby in high school. "I've been making music since eighth grade," he recalls. "Some of it was goofy, and then some of it came out kind of good... I was like, wait, I might have something here." That first project, Leftovers, sat unreleased for a while—"I didn't want to feel pretentious"—but it marked the start of a creative life rooted in authenticity.

When asked to describe his sound, AMAN resists labels. "It's primarily hip-hop, like rap shit, but I don't really feel like it sounds like anyone in particular. I try to be as authentic as possible. It's like experimental, alternative hip-hop... really just like a collage of so many different things." He draws from his own experiences, from his friends, even from moments that refuse to be scheduled. "I don't know what got me

in the mood but I couldn't sleep last night... so I just made music all night. It's kind of sporadic—you get a feeling and you just take advantage of it."

That sense of flow carries into his collaborations. "I have one friend that I primarily work with... he knows what I make and I know what he makes. You need someone you can be comfortable with," he explains. The work is intimate: "This is me, this is my life. What do you think about it?"

Music might come first, but fashion isn't far behind. "I make all types of shit... it's really for me. I like looking cool. The best way to not follow trends is to make your own stuff." He started sewing in college after his girlfriend, Carolina, taught him how to use the machines. "She always talks to me about her struggles, and I can apply the same way around problems—we inspire each other."

In five years, AMAN just wants to "live off my craft... have a space where I can do my art and not worry about the financial situation." For now, the art speaks for itself—unlabeled, unforced, and entirely his own.

